



Imagine a fuzzy, tiny creature crawling on a leaf, that's our friend, the puss caterpillar! Covered in a coat of long, silky hair, these little guys are often mistaken for cotton balls or tufts of fur. But don't be fooled, underneath that fluffy exterior, they have a dark brown body with a bright red face. A fun fact is, they're also known as 'asp' which means 'aspis' in Latin, referring to a small shield, thanks to their unique shape.



Speaking of shape, it's fun to know where these fascinating creatures call home. Puss caterpillars are found in many parts of the United States, particularly in the southern states. They love hanging out on shade trees and garden plants, so you might spot them while playing outside. Next time you're in the garden, keep an eye out for these fluffy critters!

Now that we know where to find them, let's discover what these shield-shaped bugs munch on. As caterpillars, they feed on the leaves of many different types of trees and plants. Once they've eaten enough, they form a cocoon, emerging later as a beautiful Southern Flannel Moth. Isn't it amazing how such a furry creature can transform into a graceful moth?



We've learned a lot about our fluffy friends, but there's one more surprising thing about puss caterpillars. While they look soft and cuddly, they have a secret weapon for defense – venomous spines hidden in their fur! If touched, they can cause a painful sting, so it's best to admire them from a distance. So, remember, while these cute caterpillars are fun to learn about, they're also a reminder that looks can be deceiving!



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What are puss caterpillars covered with?
A. scales B. spikes C. hair D. feathers
- 2) What is the defense mechanism of puss caterpillars?
A. toxic ooze from their abdomen B. venomous spines in their fur
C. sharp claws on each foot D. poisonous saliva in the mouth
- 3) What do puss caterpillars transform into?
A. a fur coat moth B. a monarch butterfly
C. a southern flannel moth D. a puss butterfly
- 4) What do puss caterpillars feed on?
A. small mammals B. honey from hives
C. small insects D. leaves from plants
- 5) What does the Latin word 'aspis' mean?
A. a tall tree B. a furry creature C. a small shield D. a big rock
- 6) Where would you most likely find a puss caterpillar?
A. in the desert in burrows B. in shade trees and garden plants
C. Under rocks and in leaf piles D. In rivers and swamps
- 7) What happens if you touch a puss caterpillar?
A. the caterpillar will die B. It can cause a painful sting
C. the caterpillar will see you as their owner D. the caterpillar will spit venom
- 8) What color is the body under the fluffy exterior of puss caterpillars?
A. dark brown B. bright red C. dark green D. bright white
- 9) What is another name for the puss caterpillar?
A. long fur caterpillar B. bright face caterpillar
C. fluffy worm D. Asp
- 10) What is the appearance of a puss caterpillar's face?
A. a bright red face B. a dark brown face
C. a bright yellow face D. a dark green face

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "I may look soft and cuddly, but don't be fooled, for my fluff hides venomous spines."
- 12) "When I emerge from my cocoon, instead of a butterfly, you'll see a moth."
- 13) "I hate the taste of leaves, fruits are my favorite!"
- 14) "You might mistake me for a cotton ball, my coat is so fluffy and silky."
- 15) "The southern states of the United States are where I feel most at home."
- 16) "We change from a caterpillar to a beautiful Southern Flannel Moth."
- 17) "I turn into a butterfly after leaving my cocoon."
- 18) "My shape is similar to a small shield, which is why some folks call me an 'asp.'"

- 50)** When it's time to change, they spin a cocoon and become a beautiful moth.
A. it is
B. it has
C. it am
D. it was
- 51)** Be careful not to touch them, or you'll get a painful sting.
A. you would
B. you can
C. you will
D. you have

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 52)** It's unbelievable that underneath all that fur, the puss caterpillar carries a dangerous weapon - venomous spines!
- 53)** Avoid handling puss caterpillars unless you are wearing protective gloves.
- 54)** What do puss caterpillars eat?
- 55)** It's incredible that puss caterpillars can eat so many types of leaves!
- 56)** The puss caterpillar has soft, hair-like spines that cover its body.
- 57)** How can you identify puss caterpillars?
- 58)** Puss caterpillars enjoy munching on leaves from trees like oaks, elms, and citrus plants.
- 59)** Where can we find puss caterpillars?
- 60)** Puss caterpillars can be found in the southern United States.
- 61)** Never touch a puss caterpillar.
- 62)** How amazing, the puss caterpillar transforms into a beautiful flannel moth!
- 63)** Keep an eye out for different colored puss caterpillars.



Puss Caterpillar

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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Puss Caterpillar

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---|
| 1. <u> C </u> | 26. <u> Would </u> | 51. <u> C </u> |
| 2. <u> B </u> | 27. <u> fact </u> | 52. <u> exclamatory </u> |
| 3. <u> C </u> | 28. <u> opinion </u> | 53. <u> imperative </u> |
| 4. <u> D </u> | 29. <u> fact </u> | 54. <u> interrogative </u> |
| 5. <u> C </u> | 30. <u> opinion </u> | 55. <u> exclamatory </u> |
| 6. <u> B </u> | 31. <u> fact </u> | 56. <u> declarative </u> |
| 7. <u> B </u> | 32. <u> opinion </u> | 57. <u> interrogative </u> |
| 8. <u> A </u> | 33. <u> fact </u> | 58. <u> declarative </u> |
| 9. <u> D </u> | 34. <u> fact </u> | 59. <u> interrogative </u> |
| 10. <u> A </u> | 35. <u> opinion </u> | 60. <u> declarative </u> |
| 11. <u> Would </u> | 36. <u> opinion </u> | 61. <u> imperative </u> |
| 12. <u> Would </u> | 37. <u> true </u> | 62. <u> exclamatory </u> |
| 13. <u> Not </u> | 38. <u> false </u> | 63. <u> imperative </u> |
| 14. <u> Would </u> | 39. <u> true </u> | |
| 15. <u> Would </u> | 40. <u> false </u> | |
| 16. <u> Would </u> | 41. <u> true </u> | |
| 17. <u> Not </u> | 42. <u> false </u> | |
| 18. <u> Would </u> | 43. <u> false </u> | |
| 19. <u> Would </u> | 44. <u> false </u> | |
| 20. <u> Not </u> | 45. <u> true </u> | |
| 21. <u> Not </u> | 46. <u> true </u> | |
| 22. <u> Would </u> | 47. <u> B </u> | |
| 23. <u> Would </u> | 48. <u> A </u> | |
| 24. <u> Not </u> | 49. <u> D </u> | |
| 25. <u> Not </u> | 50. <u> A </u> | |